SOUTHERN UNIVERSITY
LIFT CENTER LOGO

MBDA LOGO
(PER CURRENT BRANDING GUIDE)

PLATFORM GAP ANALYSIS

Southern University LIFT Rural Business Center

Assessment of the existing platform against MBDA Rural LIFT program requirements, including the AI Interview Tool, Proposal Generator, and Form Builder.

Program: MBDA Rural Business Center Program · MBDA-OBC-2026-00003
Recipient: Southern University and A&M College, College of Business
Prepared with: KDM & Associates, LLC — Program Management & Platform
Version: 1.0 Draft · October 25, 2026

Confidential draft for internal review. Logo placeholders will be replaced once the current MBDA branding guide is confirmed. This project is supported by the U.S. Department of Commerce, Minority Business Development Agency.

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Program	Louisiana Innovation for Thriving Rural Business (LIFT) Center — MBDA Rural Business Center Program
Award	MBDA-OBC-2026-00003 · Assistance Listing 11.805 · $1,275,000 · 3-year cooperative agreement (Sept 1, 2026 – Aug 31, 2029)
Recipient	Southern University and A&M College, College of Business (lead)
Platform partner	KDM & Associates, LLC (program management, intake/CRM/data-tracking/reporting platform per MOU §3)
Document	Gap analysis of the existing `svp-platform` codebase against Rural LIFT program requirements
Version	1.0 — Draft for review
Date	October 25, 2026
Companion document	`LIFT_System_Design.md` — design of the new modules that close the gaps identified here

1. Executive Summary

The existing KDM platform (`svp-platform`, Next.js App Router + Firebase) already contains most of the building blocks the LIFT Center needs: client registration, onboarding, cohort-based learning with certificates, surveys, events and registrations, e-signature, pipeline Kanbans, SAM.gov search with AI scoring, teaming, a proposal wizard, document storage, analytics, audit logs, and a white-label deployment module.

What the platform does **not** yet have is the program layer that MBDA judges the Center on: an evidence-backed metrics engine, outcome verification, MBDA-formatted reporting, rural eligibility, grant/invoice compliance, and program-specific roles. Two partner-supplied modules — the **AI Requirements Interview Tool** and **Adams Enterprise AI Form Builder** — are not present in this codebase but are fully specified and can be ported to close the intake, consent, survey, and evidence-collection gaps (replacing the proposed JotForm purchase).

Coverage at a glance

Program area	Rating	Summary
Platform deployment, branding, tenancy	CONFIGURE	White-label module exists; a separate LIFT deployment, MBDA branding compliance, and module toggles are needed
Staff onboarding and roles	EXTEND	User management exists; roles lack LIFT program roles and an MBDA read-only role
Partner agreements (MOUs)	BUILD	Strategic Partners list exists; no agreement-status tracking for the "80% executed" milestone
Client intake and consent	EXTEND	Client Registration closely mirrors the MBDA LOE fields; lacks rural eligibility, consent versioning, and an OMB form version
AI intake interview	BUILD	Not in codebase; port the Requirements Interview Tool with LIFT templates
Forms, surveys, evidence collection	BUILD	Survey Manager exists; port Adams Form Builder for intake/consent/evidence forms with signatures
Baseline and outcome data	BUILD	No baseline/follow-up linkage; no outcome verification workflow

Program area	Rating	Summary
Client lifecycle and case management	EXTEND	Readiness and Pipeline Kanbans exist with KDM stages; need LIFT stages and session logging
Referrals and service routing	EXTEND	Lead Routing Rules exist; need partner-destination routing and referral outcomes
Training, workshops, certificates	EXTEND	Cohorts/certificates exist but are CMMC-centric; events/webinars exist
Capital readiness	BUILD	Proof Packs and Documents can store packages; no capital pipeline or capital-infusion record
Procurement readiness and proposals	EXTEND	SAM.gov search/AI scoring is real; proposal RFP parsing and bid analysis return mock data
MBDA metrics and reporting	BUILD	Scheduled reports cover website analytics only; no program KPI engine or MBDA export
Grant compliance and invoicing	BUILD	Nothing for allowable costs, quarterly invoices, or subaward chain
AI assistant and alerts	EXTEND	AI chat (OpenAI/Ollama) exists; needs LIFT data context and off-track alerts

Top 10 gaps (priority order)

1. **MBDA metrics engine with evidence linkage** — the Center is scored on core measures; nothing computes them today.
2. **Outcome verification and evidence vault** — every Verification Method in the Year 1 matrix requires a documented artifact.
3. **LIFT intake with rural eligibility, consent, and signature** — the Q1 onboarding system must exist before the pilot (transcript, Oct 21: "We need a platform first before we start bringing people").
4. **Form Builder port** — replaces JotForm; supports MBDA consent signatures, pre-assessment surveys, and evidence forms.
5. **AI Intake Interview port** — accelerates onboarding of the 10–20 company pilot and the 477-client KDM database (Louisiana subset).
6. **Program roles and data isolation** — PII and business-confidential data require role-scoped access (MOU §5, §9).
7. **Grant compliance and invoice packet tracker** — first invoice due October 30; invoices are quarterly and require receipts.
8. **Proposal Accelerator (replace mocks)** — supports the "contracts secured" measure and faster SAM.gov RFI/RFP responses.
9. **LIFT Learning Hub** — rebrand archived webinars into on-demand courses with attendance and certificates.
10. **Partner agreement tracker** — Q1 milestone: 80% of partner agreements executed.

2. Program Baseline

2.1 Year 1 Performance Matrix (base requirements)

Source: `Requirements_table.heic` (converted and verified against `Screenshot 2026-10-21 at 5.30.05 PM.png`). Title: *Performance Matrix, Monitoring and Evaluation — Year 1 (Start-Up and Launch)*.

Quarter	Planned Activities	Quarterly Milestones	Verification Method	Responsible Agent(s)	Expected Outcome
Q1 (Months 1–3)	Staff onboarding, KDM PMO establishment, platform deployment, MOUs finalized	100% key personnel onboarded; platform operational; 80% partner agreements executed	Personnel records; signed MOUs; platform test reports; onboarding logs	Dr. Aloyce R. Kaliba, Dr. Donald R. Andrews, KDM PMO	Operational readiness within first 90 days
Q2 (Months 4–6)	Launch outreach campaigns, intake assessments, entrepreneurship training	50 clients enrolled; 10 workshops delivered; baseline data captured	CRM reports; attendance records; pre-assessment surveys	Program Managers, Entrepreneurship Institute, Ag Center	Initial client pipeline established
Q3 (Months 7–9)	Capital readiness, AM cohorts, CMMC/HUBZone training	100 cumulative clients; 15 capital packages; 10 AM/procurement completions	Loan package files; cohort completion certificates; CRM dashboards	KDM PMO, AM Laboratory, SBDC	Clients transition from training to investment readiness
Q4 (Months 10–12)	Consulting, contract matchmaking, performance review	150 clients served; 20 new businesses; 10 contracts secured	Business registration; contract documentation; annual performance report	Project Director, Evaluation Team, KDM	Year-1 targets achieved and validated

2.2 MBDA core and project-specific measures

Measure	Type	Definition (source: Project Performance Worksheet)	Verification source
Clients Served	Core	Unique clients counseled/trained (≥1 session)	Intake / CRM
New Business Starts	Core	Post-enrollment registration + qualifying activity	Registrations
Capital Infusion ($)	Core	All debt/investment from all sources	Financial documents
Jobs Supported	Core	Jobs created or retained with Center assistance	Payroll / self-report
% Businesses Realizing Revenue Growth	Core	12-month revenue increase, measured annually	Pre/post financials
Training activities delivered	Project	Workshops/courses delivered	Program logs
Capital-readiness packages	Project	Loan/investor-ready packages completed	Completed documents
Contracts secured (HUBZone/Prime/OEM)	Project	Awarded contracts documented	Contract documents
Digital adoption (e-commerce/AI users)	Project	Clients adopting e-commerce/AI tools	Surveys / usage

Measure	Type	Definition (source: Project Performance Worksheet)	Verification source
AM business-program participants	Project	Hands-on additive-manufacturing cohort	Cohort / certificate logs
CMMC / HUBZone / OZ readiness completions	Project	Certification-readiness completions	Cohort / certificate logs

MBDA assesses performance **semi-annually**; the Center reports at the 6-month mark against a straight-line interpolation of annual targets and reflects rural seasonality (Project Narrative §3.b).

2.3 Target conflicts that must be resolved

The platform will store targets as admin-configurable values seeded from the 08/31 worksheet and the Project Narrative, but the following conflicts must be confirmed by Southern, KDM, and MBDA:

Item	Requirements image / first worksheet	08/31 worksheet / Narrative / Press release	Note
Y1 Clients Served	150	100	3-yr total 650 vs 500
Y1 New Business Starts	20	10	3-yr total 100 vs 50
Y1 Contracts Secured	10	5	3-yr total 60 vs 30
Y1 Capital Infusion	$750,000 (worksheets)	$375,000 (Narrative §3.b)	3-yr $4.25M (worksheets) vs $2.125M (Narrative, press release)
Y1 Training activities	40 (both worksheets)	20 (Narrative)	08/31 3-yr total shows 75, but annual values sum to 150
Y1 Capital packages	30 (both worksheets)	15 (Narrative)	08/31 3-yr total shows 70, but annual values sum to 140
Revenue growth %	40% / 60% / 80%	20% / 30% / 40%	Year-end rate, not a quarterly sum
MBDA Client Intake & LOE form	OMB Control No. 0640-0002, *Expires 01/31/2026*	—	Confirm the current OMB-approved version before building the intake form

The budget was reduced by 50% from the original submission (Keith Moore email). The transcript (Oct 21) confirms the team is planning to "minimum expectations" while pursuing budget expansion, which reinforces configurable targets.

3. Method and Rating Scale

The analysis was performed by inspecting the `svp-platform` codebase (routes under `app/`, APIs under `app/api/`, schemas under `lib/`), the 26 non-empty source documents in `docs/SOUTHERN Requirenments/`, the Oct 21 meeting transcript, and the two partner specifications in `docs/svp-kdm-features/`.

Rating	Meaning
READY	Usable as-is for LIFT after data seeding
CONFIGURE	Branding, settings, copy, or toggles only — no code changes
EXTEND	Existing module needs code changes (new fields, stages, rules, or views)
BUILD	No suitable module exists — new module required (see System Design)

Module claims are based on the presence of routes, API handlers, and schema types. Depth of each module should be confirmed in a hands-on walkthrough before build estimates are finalized.

4. Requirement-by-Requirement Gap Matrix

4.1 Year 1 Performance Matrix traceability

ID	Requirement	Existing tool (route)	Rating	Gap	Closing module
REQ-Q1-01	Staff onboarding; 100% key personnel onboarded	User Management (`/portal/admin/user-management`), Team Members, Onboarding Management	EXTEND	No LIFT roles; no personnel-record checklist or data-reporting training tracker	M1, M5
REQ-Q1-02	KDM PMO establishment	Command Center, Tasks, Meetings, Calendar, Rocks/EOS	CONFIGURE	Rebrand and seed steering-committee cadence	M1
REQ-Q1-03	Platform deployment; platform operational	White-label (`/portal/admin/white-label`), System Health, Monitoring, QA	CONFIGURE	Separate Firebase project, domain, MBDA branding; test reports must be exportable as evidence	M1
REQ-Q1-04	MOUs finalized; 80% partner agreements executed	Strategic Partners, Agreements, NDA e-signature (`/sign/nda/[token]`)	BUILD	No agreement register, status, or % executed metric	M13
REQ-Q1-V1	Verification: personnel records, signed MOUs, platform test reports, onboarding logs	Documents, Audit Logs	BUILD	No evidence vault linking artifacts to milestones	M10
REQ-Q2-01	Launch outreach campaigns	Communications, MailChimp, GoHighLevel workflows, LinkedIn Content	CONFIGURE	LIFT templates, MBDA-compliant branding, topic-based automation	M1
REQ-Q2-02	Intake assessments; 50 clients enrolled	Client Registration (`/portal/client-registration`), Client Onboarding (`/onboarding/client`)	EXTEND	Add rural eligibility, consent, OMB version, unified client ID, enrollment status	M2, M3, M4
REQ-Q2-03	Entrepreneurship training; 10 workshops delivered	Event Manager, Events + registrations, Webinar Creator	EXTEND	Workshops must count as "training activities" and attendance must feed Clients Served	M7, M11
REQ-Q2-04	Baseline data captured	Survey Manager (`/portal/admin/surveys`)	BUILD	No baseline/follow-up pairing per client; no metric mapping	M2, M10
REQ-Q2-V1	Verification: CRM reports, attendance records, pre-assessment surveys	Analytics, event check-in	BUILD	Program KPI reports do not exist (scheduled reports are Vercel site analytics only)	M11
REQ-Q3-01	Capital readiness; 15 capital packages	Proof Packs, Documents, member attachments	BUILD	No capital package workflow, lender pipeline, or capital infusion record	M8

ID	Requirement	Existing tool (route)	Rating	Gap	Closing module
REQ-Q3-02	AM cohorts; CMMC/HUBZone training; 10 AM/procurement completions	Cohorts (admin/instructor/SME), Certificates, Consortium Readiness	EXTEND	Cohorts are CMMC-centric; need LIFT tracks and completion → metric linkage	M7
REQ-Q3-03	100 cumulative clients	Leads, Customers, Kanbans	BUILD	No de-duplicated, cumulative Clients Served count	M5, M11
REQ-Q3-V1	Verification: loan package files, cohort certificates, CRM dashboards	Documents, Certificates, Analytics	BUILD	Evidence must be attached to the outcome it proves	M10, M11
REQ-Q4-01	Consulting	Meetings, Bookings, Availability, One-to-One	EXTEND	Session logs need client, advisor, service area, hours	M5
REQ-Q4-02	Contract matchmaking; 10 contracts secured	SAM.gov Search/Monitor, AI matching, Teaming, Pursuits, Introductions	EXTEND	Award documentation and contract-value capture tied to client	M9, M10
REQ-Q4-03	20 new businesses	Client record	BUILD	Registration evidence + "post-enrollment" date logic	M10
REQ-Q4-04	Performance review; annual performance report	Analytics, Scheduled Reports	BUILD	Annual and semi-annual report packs with interpolation and evidence index	M11

4.2 Additional requirements from MOU, narrative, emails, and transcript

ID	Requirement	Source	Existing tool	Rating	Closing module
REQ-X-01	Intake, CRM, data-tracking, reporting platform that assesses needs, routes clients, monitors progress, reports against MBDA measures	MOU §3	Multiple	EXTEND	M3–M6, M11
REQ-X-02	Avoid duplication; coordinate referrals with MBDA, SBA, SBDC, APEX, EDOs, lenders	MOU §5	Lead Routing Rules	EXTEND	M6
REQ-X-03	Protect business, financial, technical, cybersecurity, and PII data; authorized access	MOU §5, §9	Firestore rules, roles	EXTEND	Cross-cutting RBAC
REQ-X-04	Records support federal reporting, audit readiness (2 CFR 200)	MOU §4, §8, §9	Audit Logs	EXTEND	M10, M12
REQ-X-05	No federal funds for direct loans, grants, equity, construction, lobbying	MOU §8	—	BUILD	M8, M12 guardrails
REQ-X-06	Separate MBDA domain, branding, email	Email to Keith/Pam (Q1)	White-label	CONFIGURE	M1

ID	Requirement	Source	Existing tool	Rating	Closing module
REQ-X-07	Capture client consent signatures (previously JotForm)	Email to Keith/Pam (Q2); transcript	NDA e-signature	EXTEND	M2, M4
REQ-X-08	Monthly metric reporting; platform maintained throughout program	Email to Keith/Pam (Q3)	—	BUILD	M11
REQ-X-09	Data captured at intake and every touchpoint; AI-queryable; flag off-track clients	Narrative §3.a	AI Chat	EXTEND	M5, M15
REQ-X-10	Single site for all activities; LMS; status by organization; notifications; scheduled reports; AI chat	Transcript (Nelinia Varenas)	Multiple	EXTEND	M1, M5, M7, M15
REQ-X-11	Webinar archive rebranded (MBDA / Rural Business Center / LIFT / Southern) as online training with sign-up and feedback	Transcript	Webinars, Webinar Creator	EXTEND	M7, M14
REQ-X-12	Pilot cohort (10–20 companies) onboarded before November; Louisiana clients from KDM's 477-client database	Transcript	Admin Users, Consortium Members	EXTEND	M3, M4
REQ-X-13	Out-of-scope (fee-based) services published with fee structures	Transcript, OZ email	Pricing, Stripe	CONFIGURE	M1 (separate from grant services)
REQ-X-14	MBDA logo usage per current branding guide (MBDA presence no smaller than Center's)	Transcript (Pam Ramos)	Header/Footer, branding	CONFIGURE	M1
REQ-X-15	Quarterly invoices with receipts; first invoice Oct 30; subaward/PO before invoicing; V+ and Pam invoice KDM, KDM invoices Southern	Transcript, E3S email	—	BUILD	M12
REQ-X-16	On-demand content for 500 clients over 3 years: webinars, podcasts, social media, mentoring	OZ email	Resources, Blog, Webinars	EXTEND	M7
REQ-X-17	Participant feedback on business impact	Transcript (Dr. Mensah)	Testimonials	EXTEND	M14
REQ-X-18	Faster SAM.gov RFI/RFP responses for small businesses	Request	Proposals wizard, SAM.gov AI	EXTEND	M9

5. Detailed Findings by Area

5.1 Tenancy, branding, and module scope — CONFIGURE

- A **White-label Deployments** module exists (`/portal/admin/white-label` , collections `whiteLabelDeployments` , `deploymentAnalytics` , `deploymentAuditLogs`).
- Decision: LIFT runs as a **separate deployment** with its own Firebase project so federal/PII client data is never co-mingled with KDM consortium data.
- MBDA branding compliance requires a configurable logo lockup and a policy check (request the current MBDA branding guide and keep the request on record, per transcript).
- KDM-only modules must be disabled (see §9).

5.2 Roles and access — EXTEND

- `TeamMemberDoc.role` is limited to `admin | team | affiliate | consultant | sme_user` ; server auth also recognizes `svpRole === "platform_admin"` .
- LIFT requires: Principal Investigator, Project Director, Program Manager, KDM PMO, Partner Advisor (SBDC, AM Lab, Law Center, Ag Center, GRS), Instructor, Evaluator, Client, and MBDA Viewer (read-only reports).
- Financial and PII fields (revenue, payroll, loan documents, ethnicity/disadvantage certification) need field-level protection.

5.3 Intake and consent — EXTEND

- `ClientRegistrationDoc` already mirrors the **MBDA FPC Client Intake & Letter of Engagement**: ownership, title, ethnicity, minority certification, address, SAM/CAGE/DUNS, NAICS, revenue, applying-as, out-of-state, in-house BD, acquisition method, referral, capability statement, teaming, resources to invest, needs.
- Missing for LIFT: parish and rural eligibility determination; MBE/disadvantage certification attestation (15 U.S.C. §9501); privacy disclosure acceptance; Acceptance of Client Relationship terms; signature with timestamp; **OMB form version**; unified client ID; enrollment date (needed for "post-enrollment" business starts); service-area selection; UEI (the form still references DUNS, which SAM.gov has replaced with UEI).
- Copy currently says "Register with KDM & Associates" and must be rebranded.

5.4 Baseline, outcomes, and evidence — BUILD

- Survey Manager (including AI survey creation and templates) exists, but responses are not linked to a client baseline record or to a 6/12-month follow-up.
- No outcome records exist for capital infusion, jobs, contracts, new starts, or revenue growth, and there is no staff verification step.
- The Year 1 matrix names a verification artifact for every milestone; the platform needs an evidence vault keyed to metric and period.

5.5 Lifecycle and case management — EXTEND

- `Readiness Kanban` and `Pipeline Kanban` exist with KDM consortium stages.

- LIFT stages: Inquiry → Intake Submitted → Eligible → Assessed → Service Plan → In Services → Outcome Pending Verification → Outcome Verified → Alumni.
- Session logging must capture client, advisor, partner, service area, date, duration, and notes; ≥1 session defines a Client Served.

5.6 Referrals and routing — EXTEND

- `Lead Routing Rules` (`/portal/admin/routing-rules` , collection `routingRules`) assigns leads to team members.
- LIFT needs routing to partner destinations (SBDC, AM Lab, Law Center, Ag Center, Entrepreneurship Institute, lenders, APEX Accelerator, GRS mentor-protégé network, V+), referral acceptance, and referral outcome feedback to prevent duplicated services.

5.7 Training and learning — EXTEND

- Cohorts (admin, instructor, SME views), curriculum, discussion, assessments, and certificates exist; catalog copy and checkout flows are CMMC-specific (`/cohorts` "CMMC Training Courses", `/checkout/cmmc-cohort`).
- Events (`EventRegistrationDoc` with check-in) and Webinar Creator exist; event registrations are payment-oriented.
- LIFT needs free, grant-funded tracks: Entrepreneurship, Capital Readiness, AM Business Program, CMMC/HUBZone/OZ Readiness, Digital/AI Adoption; webinar-to-course conversion; attendance that feeds Clients Served and Training Activities.

5.8 Capital readiness — BUILD

- Proof Packs (shareable bundles of company documents) and Documents can hold loan package files.
- Missing: capital package checklist, lender/investor pipeline, capital infusion record with source and verification, and the MOU guardrail that Center funds are never used for direct loans, grants, or equity.

5.9 Procurement readiness and proposals — EXTEND

- **Real AI today:** `lib/samgov-ai.ts` (opportunity scoring, teaming partner recommendation, teaming pitch, NAICS suggestions); `/api/ai/chat` (OpenAI or Ollama, with fallback).
- **Mock or placeholder today:** `/api/ai/rfp-processing` returns hard-coded/random results (`generateMockRfpProcessing`); `/api/ai/bid-analysis` returns `generateMockBidAnalysis` ; `/api/ai/analyze-document` and `/api/ai/analyze-screenshot` fall back to mock analysis; `/api/ai/rewrite-content` is a TODO.
- The Proposals wizard (`/portal/proposals` , types in `lib/types/proposal.ts`) supports `rfp_response` and `rfi_response` , sections, deliverables, and signature status.
- See §7 for the LIFT use of the proposal generator.

5.10 Reporting — BUILD

- `AnalyticsScheduledReportDoc` schedules **Vercel website analytics** (visitors, pageviews) — not program metrics.
- Missing: KPI definitions, configurable targets, quarterly and semi-annual roll-ups, straight-line interpolation, rural seasonality, evidence index, MBDA export, and monthly internal reports.
- The prior MBDA center model used a Salesforce-based metric evaluation that determined the score (transcript); the MBDA designated performance system format for this award must be confirmed.

5.11 Grant compliance and invoicing — BUILD

- Nothing exists for allowable-cost tagging, quarterly invoice packets, receipts, subaward/PO status, or the invoice chain (V+ and Pam Ramos → KDM → Southern Sponsored Programs).
- KDM's fiscal year is calendar-year; the subaward form question should be answered per Sponsored Programs guidance (transcript).

5.12 AI assistant and alerts — EXTEND

- AI chat and Site Assistant exist; notifications (`userNotifications`) exist.
- LIFT needs program-data context (status of any client, metric progress) with role-scoped retrieval, off-track client alerts, and scheduled briefings to leadership.

6. AI Requirements Interview Tool in the Rural LIFT Program

Source specification: `docs/svp-kdm-features/Interviewtool/inverviewtool.md` (Reusable Requirements Interview Tool, current implementation "Adams Harness / Interview Ideas to Solutions").

6.1 Current state — BUILD (port)

None of the tool's assets (`lib/adams-harness/*` , `/interview` , `/portal/solutions/*` , `/portal/admin/interviews` , `/api/public/interview/*` , `/api/adams-harness/*`) exist in this repository. The tool must be ported. Note that this repository's `hermes/` folder documents a Telegram operations agent; it is not the "Hermes" OpenAI-compatible endpoint the interview tool uses, so the port should use the spec's provider-agnostic `AI_BASE_URL` / `AI_API_KEY` / `AI_MODEL` configuration (the repo already includes the `openai` SDK).

6.2 Why it fits LIFT

The tool is designed to be re-templated: coverage topics, fact schema, output schema, branding, categories, and post-completion actions are configuration (FR-1, FR-5, FR-10, §13). It supports public (no sign-in) and authenticated modes, one question per turn, attachments (Excel, Word, PDF, PowerPoint, text), deterministic fallback when AI is unavailable, versioned outputs with SHA-256 canonical hash, approval workflow, and audit events — all of which match federal record-keeping needs.

6.3 LIFT interview templates

Template	Audience	Categories (replace "departments")	Coverage topics	Output	Post-actions
LIFT Client Intake Interview	Public + authenticated	LIFT service areas: Business Formation & Entrepreneurship, Capital Readiness, Procurement Readiness (CMMC/HUBZone/OZ/Mentor-Protégé), Advanced Manufacturing (AM Lab), Digital & AI Adoption, Agriculture	Business identity; ownership & MBE eligibility; location/parish; industry & NAICS; stage (idea / startup / operating); revenue & employees; capital needs; procurement history & registrations; certifications; digital tools; #1 need; barriers; goals (12-month); preferred services; referral source	Draft Client Intake Record + Needs Assessment + recommended Service Plan	Create draft client (M4), prefill MBDA LOE consent form (M2), route referrals (M6), schedule first advisor session
Baseline Assessment Interview	Authenticated client	Same	Revenue (last 12 months), jobs (FT/PT), payroll, capital raised to date, contracts held, digital adoption, certifications	Baseline Snapshot	Create baseline record (M10)

Template	Audience	Categories (replace "departments")	Coverage topics	Output	Post-actions
Outcome Check-in (6 and 12 months)	Authenticated client	Same	Revenue change, jobs created/retained, capital obtained (source, amount), contracts won, new registration, tools adopted	Outcome Claim set	Create outcome claims pending verification (M10); request evidence upload via form (M2)
Advisor Session Debrief	Staff / partner advisor	Service area	Services delivered, time spent, client commitments, next steps, referrals	Session Log	Append touchpoint (M5), update service plan
Partner Intake	Partner organization	Partner type (lender, SBDC, prime, OEM, university unit)	Services offered, eligibility, referral contact, capacity, data-sharing terms	Partner Profile	Create partner record and agreement task (M13)
Platform/Process Requirements (original use)	Southern and KDM staff	Center units	The spec's 15 discovery topics	Versioned specification / PRD	Feed platform backlog for later phases

6.4 Program benefits

- **Faster onboarding for the pilot and Q1/Q2 enrollment** — a conversational, mobile-friendly interview lowers the barrier for rural owners compared with a long form, and can run in a low-bandwidth, one-question-at-a-time layout.
- **Better baseline data** — structured facts with coverage tracking prevent missing baseline fields that later undermine revenue-growth and jobs measures.
- **Attachment evidence** — owners can upload financial statements, capability statements, or loan documents; the analyzer extracts summaries and generates follow-up questions.
- **Auditability** — every interview, output version, approval, and action is audited with a canonical hash.

6.5 Required LIFT controls

- **Human confirmation before data becomes official.** The interview produces a *draft* client record; staff or the client confirms, and the MBDA consent/LOE is signed through the Form Builder before the client counts as enrolled.
- **No eligibility decisions by AI.** The AI may flag likely rural/MBE eligibility; eligibility is decided by rule (parish lookup) and staff.
- **Privacy disclosure** that responses are shared with MBDA as described in the MBDA privacy disclosure; minimize data sent to the AI provider (NFR-3).
- **Prompt-injection and abuse protections** from the spec (§15): rate limits, CAPTCHA for public starts, hashed session tokens.

- **Do not port the module-build/deploy adapter** (FR-15) into the LIFT site; the PRD staging/deploy flow is only relevant to the "Platform/Process Requirements" template and should remain in the KDM build environment.

6.6 Metrics supported

Clients Served (intake → first session), baseline data captured (Q2), Jobs Supported, Revenue Growth, Capital Infusion, Contracts Secured (via outcome check-ins), and interview observability (completion rate, time to readiness).

7. Proposal Generator in the Rural LIFT Program

7.1 Current state — EXTEND

Asset	Status
`/portal/proposals` 8-step wizard; types `rfp_response`, `rfi_response`, `grant`, `mou`, `oem_supplier_readiness`	Present
SAM.gov search, monitor, sync cron (`/api/cron/samgov-sync`), AI opportunity scoring, NAICS suggestions, teaming recommendations and pitch (`lib/samgov-ai.ts`)	Present, real AI
Teaming requests/alerts, Pursuits, Proof Packs, Reps & Certs	Present
Solicitation parsing (`/api/ai/rfp-processing`)	**Mock** — returns fixed NAICS, random set-asides, sample requirements
Bid / go-no-go analysis (`/api/ai/bid-analysis`)	**Mock**
Document analysis (`/api/ai/analyze-document`)	Partial; falls back to mock
Compliance matrix (Section L/M), capability library, sources-sought/RFI templates, Word export	Not present (`docx` package is installed and can be used for export)

7.2 LIFT use: helping small businesses respond faster to SAM.gov RFIs and RFPs

Workflow

1. **Match** — SAM.gov opportunities are scored against the client's verified capability profile (existing AI scoring), filtered to Louisiana/rural-relevant set-asides (HUBZone, 8(a), WOSB, SDVOSB, Total Small Business).
2. **Ingest** — the client or advisor clicks "Respond"; the platform pulls the notice and attachments from SAM.gov and extracts text (`pdf-parse` is installed).
3. **Analyze** — real AI replaces the mocks: key dates, NAICS, set-aside, evaluation factors, mandatory requirements, certifications (CMMC level, ISO/AS9100), page limits, submission instructions.
4. **Go/No-Go** — fit score with gaps (missing certifications, past performance, capacity) and recommended teaming partners from the consortium and partner network (existing teaming AI).
5. **Compliance matrix** — every "shall/must" requirement and Section L instruction mapped to a response section and owner.
6. **Draft** — AI drafts from the client's **capability library** (company profile, capability statement, past performance, certifications, staff resumes, proof packs):
   - RFI / Sources Sought response (capabilities, relevant experience, answers to government questions) — the highest-volume, fastest win for small businesses;
   - Capability statement (one page);
   - RFP volumes (technical approach outline, management, past performance) with clear "advisor review required" markers.
7. **Review** — LIFT advisor (KDM procurement readiness lead or SBDC/APEX partner) reviews in a queue; the client approves.
8. **Export and submit** — Word/PDF export; the client submits through the official channel; the platform records submission.

9. **Outcome** — award recorded with contract documentation → verified "Contract Secured" (M10/M11).

Guardrails

- The client is the offeror; the Center coaches and reviews. AI drafts are labeled and require human review.
- No fabricated past performance or certifications — drafts may only cite capability-library facts.
- Respect solicitation page limits and formatting; never upload controlled/CUI documents to the AI provider.
- Services delivered count as counseling time (Clients Served); awards count only after verification.

Program metrics added

Responses submitted per client, median time from notice to draft, RFI/sources-sought responses (leading indicator), proposals submitted, win rate, and contracts secured.

8. Adams Enterprise AI Form Builder in the Rural LIFT Program

Source specification: `docs/svp-kdm-features/formbuilder/Adams form builder.md` (Enterprise AI Form Builder & Data Analytics Studio).

8.1 Current state — BUILD (port)

None of the builder's files (`lib/form-builder/*` , `components/portal/form-builder-renderer.tsx` , `/portal/form-builder` , `/forms/[slug]` , `/api/form-builder/*` , `/api/public/forms/[slug]`) exist in this repository. Dependencies: `recharts` and `pdf-parse` are installed; **`jsPDF` and a Word (`.docx`) parser are not** and would be new dependencies (or PDF generation can reuse the existing `puppeteer`).

8.2 Why it fits LIFT (replaces JotForm)

The team rejected JotForm because the program needs "multiple tables" and tracking across onboarding, LMS, and members (transcript). The builder provides three presentation modes (standard, conversational, imported PDF/Word overlay), 20+ controls including `signature` , `file_upload` , `likert_scale` , `nps` , `repeating_table` , and `calculated` , an AI form generator, an **AI reporting optimizer** that converts free text into dimensions and metrics, drop-off analytics, branded PDF of each submission, and a public REST/webhook API.

The **document overlay mode** is particularly valuable: the official MBDA Client Intake & LOE PDF can be imported and signed as-is, preserving the government form while capturing structured data.

8.3 LIFT form catalog

Form	Mode	Key controls	Feeds	Metric
MBDA Client Intake & Letter of Engagement (versioned by OMB control number)	Document overlay	Identity, MBE attestation, privacy agreement, acceptance of client relationship, `signature`	Client record (M4)	Clients Served (after first session)
Rural Eligibility Attestation	Standard	Address, parish `platform_lookup` , `yes_no`	Eligibility decision (M4)	—
Pre-Assessment / Baseline Survey	Conversational	`currency` revenue, `number` jobs, `likert_scale` readiness, `multi_select` needs	Baseline (M10)	Baseline data captured
Workshop Registration & Attendance	Standard	Event lookup, `yes_no` consent to contact	Events/attendance (M7)	Training activities, Clients Served
Workshop Feedback	Conversational	`nps` , `rating_stars` , `likert_scale` , `long_text`	Feedback & impact (M14)	Service quality
Outcome Evidence Submission	Standard	Outcome type `dropdown` , `currency` , `date` , `file_upload`	Evidence vault (M10)	All core measures
Capital Readiness Checklist	Standard	`repeating_table` documents, `file_upload`	Capital package (M8)	Capital-readiness packages

Form	Mode	Key controls	Feeds	Metric
Advisor Session Log	Standard	Client lookup, service area, `number` hours, `long_text`	Touchpoints (M5)	Clients Served
Partner Agreement / MOU Intake	Document overlay	Partner details, `signature`	Agreements (M13)	% partner agreements executed
Staff Onboarding Acknowledgment	Standard	Data-reporting training, confidentiality, `signature`	Personnel records (M1)	100% personnel onboarded

8.4 Required adaptations for LIFT

- **Lookup sources:** replace Adams sources (`safety_sites` , `user_assets` , etc.) with LIFT sources: `lift_clients` , `parishes` , `service_areas` , `advisors` , `partners` , `cohorts` , `events` .
- **Integrations:** enable internal routing to LIFT modules (client record, evidence vault, touchpoints, notifications, calendar) and `outbound_webhook` ; disable construction/field-service connectors (Procore, Autodesk ACC, ServiceTitan, QuickBooks) unless needed.
- **Security fix required before production.** The spec's Firestore rules allow `read: if true` on `platformForms` , and each form document stores an `apiKey` — this would expose API keys publicly. Public reads must go through a server API that returns a sanitized schema; keys must be hashed and stored separately. Submissions with `create: if true` must be rate-limited and validated server-side.
- **Storage of signatures and files:** the spec stores Base64 data URIs in Firestore documents, which risks the 1 MiB document limit and puts PII in the database. Store files and signature images in Firebase Storage with access rules; keep only references and hashes in Firestore.
- **E-signature audit trail:** capture consent text, form version, signer identity, timestamp, IP/user agent, and a hash of the signed content to support ESIGN/UETA-style evidence.
- **Form versioning:** submissions must reference the exact form version (for OMB-controlled forms and consent language).
- **Field mapping:** add declarative field-to-collection mapping so one submission can write to multiple LIFT records (the "multiple tables" requirement).
- **Interview integration:** the AI Intake Interview can prefill Form Builder forms; the form remains the signed, official record.

9. Modules to Disable on the LIFT Site

Module	Reason
Consortium membership tiers, pricing, founding-member checkout	KDM commercial offering; not a grant-funded service
Affiliate commissions, revenue config, payouts, settlements	Commission flows must not mix with federal program services
Apollo and ThomasNet contact purchasing	Purchased contact data and cost exposure
Sourcewell, TBMNC initiatives, KDM-specific marketing pages	Not in LIFT scope
Developer tools (seeders, price testing, migrate-auth, init-collections)	Not for production program staff
CMMC paid cohort checkout	LIFT training is free; paid follow-on work must be clearly separated and optional

Stripe and the Pricing page may remain only for clearly labeled **out-of-scope, fee-based services**, separate from grant-funded services.

10. Risk Register

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
Zero results in Q1 because the platform is not ready	High	Medium	Phase 0 pilot: intake form + signature + webinar archive by Nov 10
Unconfirmed targets and MBDA reporting format	High	High	Configurable targets; reporting adapter; confirm with MBDA at orientation
PII/confidential data exposure	High	Medium	Separate deployment, role-scoped rules, Storage for files, audit
AI hallucination in proposals or intake	Medium	Medium	Human review gates, capability-library-only drafting, labeled AI output
Ported modules carry Adams-specific assumptions	Medium	High	Port per spec portability phases; remove Adams connectors
Invoice delays (subaward/PO not yet issued)	High	High	Compliance tracker with PO status; evidence packets ready
MBDA branding non-compliance	Medium	Medium	Request current branding guide; configurable lockup
Budget reduction limits build capacity	High	High	Phase by invoice milestones; reuse existing modules first

11. Prioritized Remediation Roadmap

Phase	Window	Modules	Outcome
Phase 0 — Pilot readiness	Now → Nov 10	M1 Tenant & Branding; M2 Form Builder (intake/consent form only); M4 Intake & Eligibility (basic); M7 webinar archive	Pilot companies onboarded with signed consent; Q1 evidence
Phase 1 — Public launch	→ ~Nov 19 (mobile CAVE launch / AM Lab ribbon cutting)	M3 AI Intake Interview; M5 Lifecycle; M6 Routing; M13 Agreements; M15 Assistant (basic)	Public intake, pipeline visibility, partner tracking
Phase 2 — Q2 operations	Months 4–6	M8 Capital; M9 Proposal Accelerator; M10 Evidence Vault; M11 Metrics & Reporting; M12 Grant Compliance	Evidence-backed metrics and semi-annual report
Phase 3 — Optimization	Months 7+	M14 Feedback & Impact; M15 alerts and briefings; enhancements	Adaptive management and sustainability

12. Open Questions

1. Which Year 1 targets are authoritative (see §2.3)?
2. What is MBDA's designated performance system for this award, and what is its import format and cadence?
3. Which OMB-approved version of the Client Intake & LOE form must be used, and must clients sign it, or is electronic consent acceptable?
4. Which geography defines "rural" for eligibility (e.g., USDA, Census, or MBDA definition), and are urban-parish clients ever eligible?
5. Who owns the LIFT data after August 31, 2029, and what retention period applies?
6. Which LIFT staff roles exist, and who may see financial and PII fields?
7. Which partners need platform logins versus email referrals only?
8. Which AI provider and model are approved for client data, and may client documents be sent to it?
9. Are interview and form responses from the KDM pilot companies counted as LIFT clients (and with what consent)?
10. What are the out-of-scope services and fee structures, and who invoices them?
11. Which existing webinars are cleared for rebranding, and who approves MBDA logo usage?
12. What is the quarterly invoice schedule after October 30, and what supporting documentation does Sponsored Programs require?

Appendix A. Source Documents

File	Used for
`Requirements_table.heic`, `Screenshot 2026-10-21 at 5.30.05 PM.png`	Year 1 Performance Matrix (baseline)
`LIFTProjectPerformanceWorksheetFinal.pdf`, `..._08_31.pdf`	Quarterly targets and definitions
`MBDA Rural Center Performance metrics.pdf`	Theory of change, measures, start-up plan
`MOU_KDM and Associates_Southern_University_LIFT_Rural_MBDA_Center.docx.pdf`	Roles, data, compliance
`Brian-Stitt-MBDAFPC-Client-LOE.pdf`	MBDA intake form fields
`Edited C. Sills - DRAFT MBDA LIFT Rural Center Press Release_09_29_26 (1).docx`	Award amount, 3-year goals, leadership
`email content.md.txt`, `southern_email_keith.txt.txt`, `Keith_email_brian.txt`, `southern_oportunity_zone_email.txt.txt`, `southern_E3S_email.txt`	Branding, consent, reporting, content, budget
`southern_transcript.md` (Oct 21 meeting)	Platform priorities, pilot, invoicing, branding
`Letter of Support -GRS.pdf`, `2026 Southern_University_Federal_Contracting_Capability_Brief.pdf`	Partner capabilities
`docs/svp-kdm-features/Interviewtool/inverviewtool.md`	AI interview tool specification
`docs/svp-kdm-features/formbuilder/Adams form builder.md`	Form builder specification

ITAC, Opportunity Zone media, and E3S revenue-sharing materials were reviewed but are out of scope for this analysis. Empty files: `southern_transcript2.txt.txt`, `brian_response_southern.txt`, `southern_meet_KDM.txt`, `southern_press_release.txt`.

Appendix B. Requirements Table (source image)

